

Microsoft 365 Copilot Analytics

Attribute Reference

Complete attribute mapping, data classification, and naming conventions for organisational data

Document Property	Value
Section	Reference
Audience	IT Admin, Insights Admin
Version	4.0
Published	April 2026

How This Document Fits

This is a **Reference** guide. Use it when preparing CSV uploads or configuring HRIS connectors. For the step-by-step upload process, see the Data Onboarding Guide.

Section	Purpose	Who Reads
Strategy	Decide what to implement	CIO, SA, Business Leaders
Setup	Configure and deploy	IT Admin, Insights Admin
Operate	Use dashboards and reports daily	Leaders, Analysts, Managers
Reference (you are here)	Look up details and fix issues	Everyone (as needed)

Table of Contents

- 1. Attribute Mapping Table
- 2. Data Classification

3. Naming Conventions

4. Reserved Attribute Names

5. Microsoft Learn References

1. Attribute Mapping Table

This table maps legacy Viva Insights attribute names to the new M365 Admin Center naming convention (MODIS). Use this when migrating from the legacy upload path or preparing a new CSV.

Legacy Name (Viva Insights)	M365 Admin Center Name	Required?	Display Name
PersonId	Microsoft_PersonEmail	Required	Employee Email
ManagerId	Microsoft_ManagerEmail	Required	Manager Email
Organization	Microsoft_Organization	Required	Department
EffectiveDate	N/A (date picker in UI)	Required (legacy) / Not needed (new)	Leave Start Date
FunctionType	Microsoft_JobDiscipline	Optional	Department
LevelDesignation	Microsoft_LevelDesignation	Optional	Employee Level
Location	Microsoft_CompanyOfficeLocation	Optional	Department
HireDate	Microsoft_HireDate	Optional	Start Date
HourlyRate	Microsoft_HourlyRate	Optional	Cost Rate
Layer	Microsoft_Layer	Optional	Hierarchy Level
SupervisorIndicator	Microsoft_SupervisorIndicator	Optional	Is Supervisor
Custom (e.g., BusinessUnit)	Custom (same name)	Optional	User ID

2. Data Classification

When uploading organisational data, each attribute is assigned an access classification that controls which applications and roles can read the data.

Classification	Visibility	Example At
Public	Visible to all users and all apps that consume Viva Insights data.	Organizat
Confidential	Visible only to apps and roles you explicitly choose. Not available for dashboard filters.	HourlyRat
Custom	You choose which apps and roles can access the attribute (per-attribute granularity).	Any custom

Best Practice

Set `HourlyRate` and any compensation-related attributes to **Confidential**. Set demographic attributes like `Organization`, `Location`, and `FunctionType` to **Public** so they are available as dashboard filters.

3. Naming Conventions

Rule	Details
Use underscores, not spaces	Column names must not contain spaces. Use <code>Business_Unit</code> or <code>Bu</code>
No <code>Microsoft_</code> prefix for custom attributes	The <code>Microsoft_</code> prefix is reserved for system attributes. Custom co
Case sensitivity	Attribute names are case-insensitive during upload but are stored as
Maximum length	Attribute names should not exceed 128 characters.
Total attribute limit	Maximum of 105 total attributes per upload (reserved system attrib
Avoid special characters	Use only letters, numbers, and underscores. Avoid hyphens, periods,

4. Reserved Attribute Names

The following attribute names are reserved by the system and **cannot be used for custom attributes**. If you need a similar concept, use a different name (e.g., `Agency_Location` instead of `Location`).

Reserved Name (Legacy)	Reserved Name (M365 Admin Center)
<code>PersonId</code>	<code>Microsoft_PersonEmail</code>
<code>ManagerId</code>	<code>Microsoft_ManagerEmail</code>
<code>Organization</code>	<code>Microsoft_Organization</code>
<code>EffectiveDate</code>	N/A (UI-based)
<code>FunctionType</code>	<code>Microsoft_JobDiscipline</code>
<code>LevelDesignation</code>	<code>Microsoft_LevelDesignation</code>
<code>Location</code>	<code>Microsoft_CompanyOfficeLocation</code>
<code>HireDate</code>	<code>Microsoft_HireDate</code>
<code>HourlyRate</code>	<code>Microsoft_HourlyRate</code>
<code>Layer</code>	<code>Microsoft_Layer</code>
<code>SupervisorIndicator</code>	<code>Microsoft_SupervisorIndicator</code>

Important

Any custom attribute name beginning with `Microsoft_` will be rejected during validation. If you need to add custom attributes with similar concepts, use your own naming convention (e.g., `Agency` , `CostCentre` , `Region`).

5. Microsoft Learn References

Topic	Link
Organizational Data in Microsoft 365	learn.microsoft.com/viva/organizational-data
Org Data Attribute Reference	learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/admin/org-data-overview
Prepare Organisational Data (CSV)	learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/admin/prepare-org-data
Validation Errors	learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/admin/rules-validation-errors
Data Quality Page	learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/admin/data-quality

Disclaimer: This document is provided for informational purposes only and reflects Microsoft 365 capabilities as of April 2026. Microsoft may change features, interfaces, and availability without notice. Always verify current guidance on Microsoft Learn. This document is not official Microsoft documentation and should not be treated as a definitive source for product capabilities or licensing requirements.